

On 20 January 2027, Australia's import conditions for nursery stock will be updated in accordance with the department's [final pest risk analysis for bacterial pathogens in the Xylella genus](#).

Offshore laboratories seeking to conduct testing of plants for Xylella can now apply for registration under the [Xylella Laboratory Authorisation Program](#).

The emergency measures outlined below will remain in place until conditions are updated.

Check Biosecurity Import Conditions ([BICON](#)) for all import conditions applying to your goods.

Emergency measures

Emergency measures are currently in place to manage the risk of Xylella entering Australia via imported host plants and some seed species.

These emergency measures were introduced in 2015 to ensure that at-risk material is free from Xylella infection.

The emergency measures target Xylella fastidiosa, Xylella taiwanensis and all of their sub-species. The sub-species of X. fastidiosa include: fastidiosa, multiplex, pauca, sandyi, tashke and pear leaf scorch (PLS; now called 'Xylella taiwanensis').

In this document 'Xylella' refers to the species Xylella fastidiosa and all of its sub-species, and Xylella taiwanensis.

19 November 2015	The additional import requirements came into effect for nursery stock belonging to a regulated plant family, and imported from high-risk countries or regions:
19 January 2016	Country freedom certification requirements were introduced for nursery stock belonging to a regulated family, that is sourced from low-risk countries or regions.
6 July 2019	Addition of Israel as a high-risk country.
3 August 2020	Emergency measures for nursery stock were expanded to include 9 new plant families: Cannaceae, Gesneriaceae, Linaceae, Polemoniaceae, Resedaceae, Scrophulariaceae, Simmondsiaceae, Strelitziaceae and Tamaricaceae.
1 June 2021	Emergency measures for nursery stock were expanded to 7 new plant families: Araucariaceae, Argophyllaceae, Athyriaceae, Corynocarpaceae, Dennstaedtiaceae, Haloragaceae and Violaceae.
5 November 2021	Emergency measures for nursery stock were expanded to the plant family, Hypericaceae.
20 May 2022	Additional import requirements came into effect for Carya spp. seeds for sowing, based on new evidence demonstrating the potential for Xylella to be transmitted from pecan seeds to pecan seedlings.

8 December 2023	Emergency measures for nursery stock were expanded to the plant family, Simaroubaceae.
31 January 2025	Addition of China as a high-risk country and introduction of plant genus level regulation for China only.
11 April 2025	Inclusion of Cannabis, Monadenium, Pedilanthus and Synadenium as plant genera regulated for Xylella.
17 April 2025	Introduction of genus level regulation for countries and regions other than China.
28 April 2025	Addition of Iraq as a high-risk country.
19 June 2025	Inclusion of Nyssa, Punica and Smilax as plant genera regulated for Xylella.
4 July 2025	Inclusion of Iochroma and Neillia as plant genera regulated for Xylella.
13 March 2026	Expansion of emergency measures to Musa as a regulated plant genus for Xylella.
17 June 2026	Inclusion of Acmena, Allardtia, Anoplophytum, Calylophus, Daphne, Dendropogon, Diaphoranthema, Gaura, Liriope, Parahebe, Phytarrhiza, Pityrophyllum, Platystachys, Renealmia, Saintpaulia, Strepsia, Uncinia and Viridantha as plant genera regulated for Xylella.

Requirements for nursery stock

The emergency measures for nursery stock apply to tissue cultures, rooted plants, cuttings, budwood, some corms and bulbs that are hosts of Xylella, imported from countries and regions where Xylella is known to be present.

The emergency measures are applied in addition to current import requirements.

Key import requirements to manage the risk of Xylella in nursery stock include:

- Tissue cultures grown in high-risk Xylella countries/regions will need to be tested offshore using DAFF-approved methodologies, and certified as free from Xylella on a phytosanitary certificate.
- Non tissue culture nursery stock and plant material from high-risk Xylella countries/regions must be grown under an offshore approved arrangement in accordance with Australia's requirements. An arrangement will need to be in place prior to offshore certification of nursery stock.
- Material that does not meet the requirements may be (i) held and tested in an approved post-entry quarantine facility for 12 months or (ii) subject to hot water treatment, followed by standard post-entry quarantine screening arrangements.

Note: Some plant species currently categorised as high-risk nursery stock are not affected by the changes because Xylella testing requirements are already in place.

Phytosanitary certification will also be required for plants imported from countries or regions where *Xylella* does not occur. This is to provide assurance that these countries or regions are free from this bacterium.

[Check Biosecurity Import Conditions \(BICON\)](#) for all import conditions that apply to your goods.

List of appendixes

Country category	Off-shore certification	On-shore action if the Phytosanitary Certificate is acceptable (see note 3)	On-shore measures for consignments without an acceptable Phytosanitary Certificate
High risk countries/ regions	A Phytosanitary Certificate with the following Additional Declaration or equivalent words: “All tissue cultures in this consignment were derived from mother tissue cultures that were tested by PCR and found free of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> as indicated on laboratory test report number [insert number/code here].” (See note 4)	All other current import conditions for the plant species will apply	Tissue cultures must be de-flasked and grown for a minimum of 12 months in a government PEQ (see note 1) before testing by PCR. All plants will be tested. A positive detection of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> will result in destruction of the consignment. All other current import conditions for the plant species will apply. OR Export or disposal
All other countries and regions	A Phytosanitary Certificate with the following Additional Declaration or equivalent words: “Tissue cultures in this consignment were derived from plants and tissue cultures that were grown only in [insert country] which is free from <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i>”	All other current import conditions for the plant species will apply.	Tissue cultures must be de-flasked and grown for a minimum of 12 months in PEQ (private or government) (see note 1) before testing by PCR. All plants will be tested. A positive detection of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> will result in destruction of the consignment. All other current conditions for the plant species will apply.

OR

Export or disposal

Country category (see note 5)	Off-shore certification	Action if the Phytosanitary Certificate is acceptable (see note 3)	On-shore measures for consignments that come without an acceptable Phytosanitary Certificate
High risk countries/ regions	A Phytosanitary Certificate with the following Additional Declaration or equivalent words: “Plant material in this consignment was produced under an arrangement approved by the National Plant Protection Organisation in accordance with Australian requirements. Plant material in this consignment was tested by PCR and found free of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> as indicated on laboratory test report number [insert number/code here].” (See note 2)	Current import conditions for the plant species apply.	Plants will be grown for a minimum of 12 months in government PEQ (see note 1) before testing by PCR. All plants will be tested. A positive detection of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> will result in destruction of the consignment.
			All other current conditions for the plant species will apply. OR Plants will be hot-water treated at 50°C for 45 minutes. Following treatment, all other conditions for the plant species will apply. OR Re-export or destroy.
All other countries and regions	A Phytosanitary Certificate with the following Additional Declaration: “Plant material in this consignment and its parent stock were grown only in [insert country] which is free from <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> ”	Current import conditions for the plant species apply.	Plants will be grown for a minimum of 12 months in PEQ (private or government) (see note 1) before testing by PCR. All plants will be tested. A positive detection of <i>Xylella fastidiosa</i> will result in destruction of the consignment. All other current conditions for the plant species will apply.

OR

Plant will be hot-water treated at 50°C for 45 minutes. Following treatment, all other conditions for the plant species will apply.

OR

Re-export or destroy.

Notes

- There are scheduled fees associated with the growth of nursery stock in an Australian Government post- entry quarantine facility, which must be met by the importer. The importer is responsible for contacting the facility to confirm all arrangements, including space availability and number of plants, prior to the plant material arriving in Australia. Importers must clearly nominate the facility that their material will be sent to on the import permit application.
- Nursery stock and tissue cultures from high-risk countries/regions must be produced through an arrangement approved by the National Plant Protection Organisation of the exporting country to meet Australia's requirements (Appendix 3). These arrangements have also been distributed to NPPOs through the [IPPC notification](#).
- We will reserve the right to undertake testing to verify that a consignment is free of *Xylella*.
- PCR tests that will detect *Xylella* including recognised sub-species. PCR testing will require the following two tests:
 - the rimM gene sequence real-time PCR test of Harper et al. (2010)¹¹
 - the conventional PCR of Minsavage et al. (1994)² or an equivalent PCR that detects *X. fastidiosa* sub-species pear leaf scorch (PLS).
- the rimM gene sequence real-time PCR test of Harper et al. (2010)

Note: As of June 2026, there are currently no offshore approved arrangements in place for nursery stock from high-risk countries/regions.

These requirements are for offshore arrangements approved under Australia's emergency measures for *Xylella*. The requirements apply to nursery stock of plants exported from high-risk countries/regions. Offshore approved arrangements are currently not available for imports of true botanical seeds that can transmit *Xylella*.

This section is about the overarching systems and processes to ensure that nursery stock produced for export to Australia is grown, tested and confirmed free from infection by *X. fastidiosa*.

The National Plant Protection Organisation (NPPO) of the exporting country will approve the arrangements and ensure that the requirements are met. Several other parties, including the grower and testing laboratory will need to work with the NPPO to do this. The supplier will contact the NPPO

of the exporting country to establish the arrangements. Australian importers should contact their overseas suppliers to ensure that the work is initiated for the arrangements.

The arrangements

The arrangements require these elements:

- Propagation, growth, testing, certification and export under the authority of the NPPO of the exporting country
- The facility where plants are grown is insect-proof so that it excludes all insects of the suborder Auchenorrhyncha (leafhoppers, froghoppers, sharpshooters, spittlebugs and treehoppers)
- Plants for export to Australia are grown for their entire life in the facility regardless of the propagation technique used (e.g. plants grown from seed, grown vegetatively or grown in tissue culture)
- All the mother plants are tested for *X. fastidiosa* by the approved [protocol](#) up to 8 weeks before export:
 - nursery stock– the mother plants that are the immediate source from which the nursery stock plant lot was propagated are tested. This includes the mother tissue cultures or the mother plants that directly provided the material used to propagate the nursery stock plant lot.
 - Mother plants or mother tissue cultures will have been grown and protected within the facility for 12 months before testing. ([Diagram 1](#))
- Prior to export, an official sample is drawn from the plant lot and tested according to the approved protocol for *X. fastidiosa* detailed in the [PCR testing requirements](#).
- Plant consignments are packed and packaged to prevent infection by *X. fastidiosa*
- Phytosanitary certificates issued by the NPPO with additional declarations including information that enables tracing of plant lines for export to Australia to test results and the facility in which the lines were grown.

Roles and responsibilities

The exporter and the testing laboratory should verify the requirements before the testing. We retain the right to monitor the arrangements by auditing and by sampling and testing consignments after they arrive in Australia.

The NPPO

The NPPO will provide oversight of the arrangements to ensure that they meet the requirements. The NPPO is responsible for approving facilities or authorising any independent entities that approve facilities on its behalf. We may request that the NPPO provide records relevant to the approval and management of the arrangements.

The NPPO or an entity acting under the authority of the NPPO will:

- Inspect the production facility to confirm that:
 - phytosanitary requirements are met
 - the facility is insect proof
 - the facility is constructed and equipped to achieve requirements
 - records are maintained by the producer or the facility.
- Approve the facility under the arrangement
 - audit the facility and records
- Approve sampling of mother plants by the grower for testing or take samples of mother plants
- Take official samples of the plant lot for testing
- Maintain records of:
 - approved facilities
 - audits of facilities
 - phytosanitary practices within facilities
 - laboratory tests for *X. fastidiosa*.
- Certify that plants exported to Australia are free from *X. fastidiosa*. This will be based on evidence of systems that confirm:
 - plants were kept in the registered facility throughout their life, from propagation to export
 - testing has been undertaken by a competent laboratory and laboratory reports have been sighted.
- Phytosanitary Certificates must include:
 - additional declarations that indicate the status of the plant lot
 - the facility approval code/number
 - the laboratory report code/number.

The grower

The grower will ensure that:

- phytosanitary conditions for Australia are met
- plants are appropriately tested by an approved testing laboratory
- samples of mother plants for testing are provided, if approved by NPPO
- the facility is free from *X. fastidiosa*
- the facility is insect-proof.

The grower will also ensure that

- complete records are maintained of:
 - plant lot identifying numbers or codes
 - the parentage of the exported plant lots
 - dates that plants are introduced to the facility

- mother plants, i.e. plants that are the immediate propagation source from which plant lots were propagated
- pathogens detected in plants in the facility
- arthropods found in the facility
- any plant material destroyed and the reason for the destruction.
- all plants for export to Australia are transported in insect-proof closed containers or packaging.

The testing laboratory

The testing laboratory is approved by the NPPO as competent to undertake the testing required by Australia, using the prescribed testing methods.

It will:

- use the approved test protocol
- record the plant lots or mother plants that are tested and the number of samples tested
- provide the evidence of tests, results and operating processes to the NPPO, as required.

[Diagram 1](#): How the management system works

Requirements for seeds for sowing

Australia's emergency measures for managing the risk of *Xylella* in seeds are currently limited to *Carya* spp. seeds that are imported for sowing (planting) purposes.

To address the risk posed by *Xylella*, seeds must be held and tested in an approved post-entry quarantine facility for 12 months to confirm freedom from *Xylella*. This requirement applies regardless of the country of origin or export.

[Check Biosecurity Import Conditions \(BICON\)](#) for all import conditions apply to your import.

Requirements for PCR testing

This section provides the requirements for PCR testing to meet Australia's emergency measures for *Xylella fastidiosa*.

Testing must follow the PCR protocols and should be done when the bacteria are easiest to detect. This is usually when leaves are mature, before senescence, and typically from late summer or in autumn for perennials.

PCR testing will require the following two tests:

- rimM gene sequence real-time PCR test from Harper et al. (2010)¹
- conventional PCR from Minsavage et al. (1994)² or an equivalent PCR that detects *X. fastidiosa* sub-species pear leaf scorch (PLS).

To ensure accurate testing:

- The sample size (number of units) will be set according to Table 1 in ISPM 313

Ensuring a 95% confidence level that *X. Fastidiosa* is not present in more than 0.5% (level of detection) of each lot. A unit defined as an individual plant.

- Two tissue samples per unit will be tested from tissue cultures, bulbs and corms.
- Three tissue samples per unit will be tested from nursery stock plants and cuttings.
- Mid-ribs of leaves must be included in the sample if the plant has leaves.
- Living tissue with vascular structures will be sampled if the material has no leaves.

Note: a unit is a tissue culture plantlet, nursery stock plant, a bulb or a corm.

For efficient PCR testing:

- DNA extracted from up to 10 samples may be tested in a single PCR as a pool or batch, where a sample is defined as a single piece of tissue.
- samples from different species should not be pooled.

For accurate results:

- House-keeping gene positive controls must be run for each batch of tests to confirm that the DNA was extracted successfully.
- House-keeping positive controls must be run for each different plant species.

For proper documentation and certification:

- The laboratory must record the plant lots and mother plants that are tested and the number of samples tested.
- If the testing is conducted prior to export (nursery stock only) the:
 - exporting NPPO must verify the laboratory report and retain a copy, and
 - identifying code or number of the laboratory report must be provided on the Phytosanitary Certificate.
 - DAFF reserve the right to request copies of the lab test reports to verify compliance with the import conditions.

Harper, S. J., Ward, L. I., and Clover, G. R. G. (2010). Development of LAMP and real-time PCR methods for the rapid detection of *Xylella fastidiosa* for quarantine and field applications. *Phytopathology* 100:1282-1288.

Minsavage, G.V., Thompson, C.M., Hopkins, D.L., Leite, M.V.B.C. and Stall, R.E. (1994) Development of a Polymerase Chain Reaction protocol for detection of *Xylella fastidiosa* in plant tissue. *Phytopathology* 84: 456-461.

ISPM 31 in International Standards for Phytosanitary Methods, No. 1 to 32 (2009), the Secretariat of the International Plant Protection Convention, Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, Rome. pp. 401–420. <https://www.ippc.int/en/publications/588/>

See more

- [Xylella and exotic vectors](#) - Fact sheet
- [Xylella fastidiosa](#) - Plant Health Australia
- [Measures for Xylella](#)
- [Upcoming changes to import conditions for Xylella host nursery stock](#)

Contact us

For any additional enquiries email to imports@aff.gov.au

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/plant-products/how-to-import-plants/xylella-host-nursery-stock/emergency-measures-for-xylella-current>